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HOME NOT FOUND

A Visual Report on Ireland's Housing Breakdown (2012–2024)



Divyansh Sharma , February 2026

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Comprehensive Analysis of Irish Housing Market (2012-2024)

Project Overview

This analysis delivers the first comprehensive, county-level examination of Ireland's housing crisis, combining property prices, earnings data, and construction metrics from 2012-2024. Using advanced data integration techniques and AI-assisted development, the project produced both interactive dashboards and public-ready visualizations to inform policy discussions and regional planning decisions.

Data Integration & Methodology

Sources: Central Statistics Office (CSO) Census, residential property prices, household earnings, dwelling completions, and floor area data, supplemented by EU comparative datasets. ESRI, Pensions Council.

Geographic Standardization: Resolved data fragmentation by mapping settlement-level and LEA-level records to unified county boundaries, handling inconsistent naming conventions through automated text normalization.

AI-Enhanced Development

Leveraged multiple AI agents to accelerate project delivery and enhance analytical depth:

- **Data Processing:** Automated cleaning scripts, inconsistency detection, and validation workflows
- **Code Generation:** Python automation for data merging and statistical calculations
- **Visualization:** Tableau dashboard optimization and color scheme development
- **Documentation:** Narrative structuring and methodology explanations

AI integration reduced development time by approximately 60% while maintaining rigorous analytical standards.

Key Metrics:

- **Affordability Ratio** = Median house price ÷ Annual earnings
- **Price per m²** = Sale price ÷ Dwelling size
- **Construction output trends by county and year**
- **Construction output trends by county and year**

Technical Challenges Resolved

Data Fragmentation: Different datasets reported at varying geographic levels and time spans.

Solution: Developed keyword-based mapping rules to standardize all records to county-year granularity.

Missing Data: Significant gaps in pre-2012 and 2024 records.

Solution: Implemented transparent data quality indicators and clearly marked incomplete periods in all visualizations

Naming Inconsistencies: County names varied across sources.

Solution: Created comprehensive normalization protocols handling diacritical marks and spelling variations.

Deliverables & Impact

Interactive Dashboard: Tableau-based exploration tool with year, county, and metric filtering enabling dynamic analysis for policymakers and researchers.

Public Report: Adobe Suite designed infographics optimized for media distribution and public engagement.

Open Data: Cleaned datasets published to Kaggle and GitHub, enabling continued research and analysis by academic and policy communities.

Policy Applications: Findings directly support arguments for regional economic diversification, increased public housing investment, and targeted affordability interventions in high-pressure counties.

Public Engagement: Visual narratives translate complex housing economics into accessible formats, enabling informed citizen participation in housing policy debates.

SHAPING THE STORY

Ireland's Housing Crisis in Numbers

Housing affordability has become Ireland's defining challenge. This analysis examines a custom built dataset across all 26 counties from 2012-2024 to quantify the crisis scale and identify underlying causes.

The data reveals unprecedented market failure: house prices doubled while dwelling sizes contracted by 42%. Construction output failed to respond to obvious profit signals, creating annual housing deficits that compound yearly.

About The Data

The dataset used in this report is part of a larger analytical project and is accompanied by an interactive Tableau dashboard. It was custom-built by merging and cleaning multiple datasets from the Central Statistics Office (CSO) Ireland.

Key datasets referenced include:

- NEA08
- NDA05
- NDA02
- HPA02

Links to the dashboard and master dataset, along with the Jupyter Notebook used for preprocessing and analysis, is publicly available on Kaggle and GitHub, linked at the end.

COUNTY ZYT

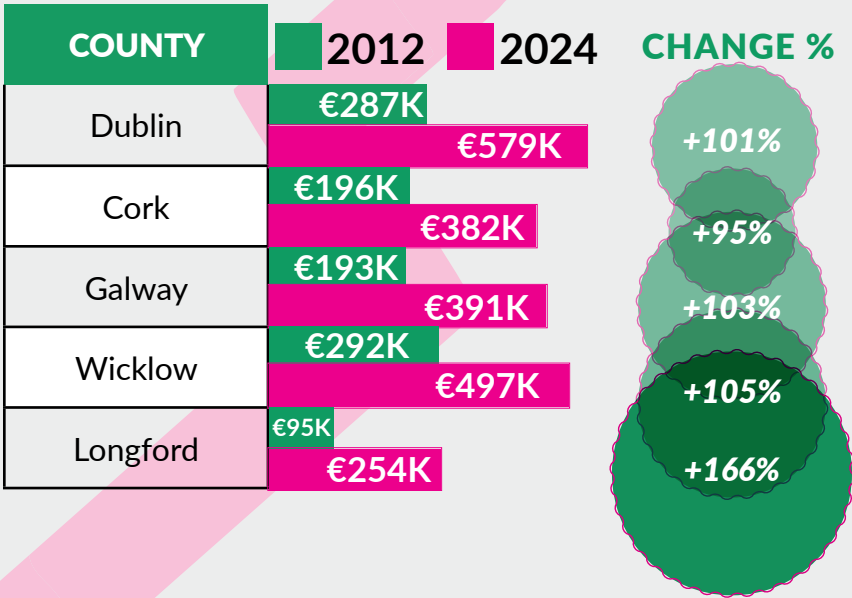
WHAT'S GOING ON?

THE EXPLOSION

Every county experienced unprecedented price acceleration. Dublin doubled, but rural counties saw even higher percentage increases, proving this is a nationwide crisis, not just a Dublin problem.



Mean Dwelling Prices by County



THE COLLAPSE

Irish workers are mathematically excluded from homeownership. A deposit in Dublin now requires more than an entire year's salary, making homeownership dependent on inheritance rather than work.

Median House Price: €563,000

Required Deposit (10%): €56,300

Median Annual Salary: €47,900

Deposit = 1.2 Years of Entire Salary

COUNTY	AFF. RATIO
Dublin	11.8x
Wicklow	10.6x
Cork	8.2x
Galway	8.2x
INTL. STANDARD	3-4X

Year 2023

It will take an average Dublin resident more than 10 years of their salary to be able to buy a home.

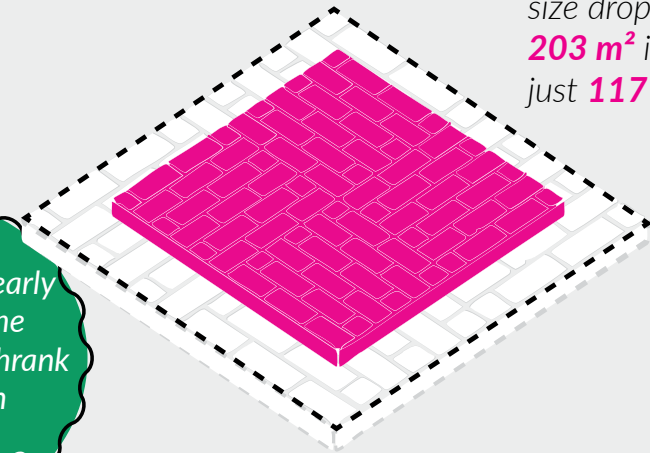
This puts Dublin's Affordability ratio at more than 10x. The global average for affordable housing is considered to be 3-4x.

While Prices Nearly Doubled over the years, houses shrank by upto 40% on average.

THE SHRINKING

Irish families face a unique crisis: paying dramatically more for significantly less. The average home lost 86 square meters—equivalent to losing an entire apartment while prices doubled.

The Average dwelling size dropped from **203 m²** in 2012 to just **117 m²** in 2024.



That's a reduction of

42%

THE NEW ENTRY BARRIER

Who can still buy in Ireland?

The age at which a majority of householders own their home has shifted forward by a decade, from 26 in 1991 to 36 in 2022. Two-thirds ownership is now not reached until age 44.

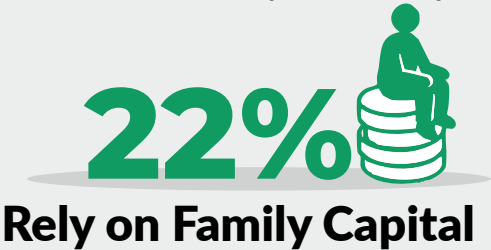


Changeover Age, Census 2022, CSO

Homeownership has moved from early adulthood to mid-career, reflecting prolonged entry barriers and extended reliance on private rental.

DEPOSIT & INTEGRATIONAL SUPPORT

Entry Now Requires Financial Flexibility



Purchase before having children

BORROWING CAPACITY IS NOW DETERMINED BY HOUSEHOLD STRUCTURE

Average income:

- Joint purchasers: €101,200
- Sole purchasers: €55,100

CURRENT AGE GROUP	EXPECTED HOMEOWNERSHIP % AT RETIREMENT
65+	90%
55-64	80%
45-54	79%
35-44	65%
25-34	40%

For the 25–34 age group, the homeownership rate at retirement is projected to be only 40%, a 50 percent-age-point drop compared to current retirees. If these individuals remain in the private rental sector, they will require significantly higher retirement incomes to avoid poverty.

Pensions Council observations/ESRI simulated rates

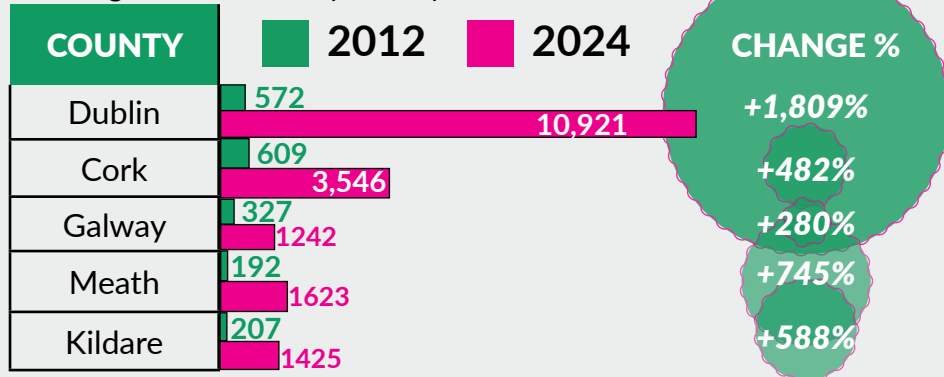
WHAT NOW?

JUST BUILD MORE HOMES?

They're trying..... kind of.....

Despite massive profit signals, construction is moving backwards. Even Dublin—with 1,809% construction growth since 2012—builds only one home per 128 residents. Ireland's construction response remains inadequate to population pressures.

Dwellings Constructed By County



2012-2016 Average: 26,845 units/year

2020-2024 Average: 29,680 units/year

That's only an 11% increase while prices rose beyond 100% in some areas



JUST FIX IT!

SOLUTION? LOOK EAST

Vienna can act as a role model

Vienna proves state housing can be both high-quality and financially sustainable. However, replicating their success in Ireland requires overcoming significant institutional, political, and cultural barriers that took Austria a century to develop.

- Phase One:
Pilot projects in Dublin, Cork, Galway (5,000 units)
- Phase Two:
Scale to 15,000 units annually with design standards
- * Phase Three:
Full program targeting 25,000 units annually



*I'm sure it's a little more complicated, but lets leave that to the policy makers :)

The Vienna Model

- Municipal ownership: City builds and owns housing stock
- Cross-subsidization: Higher earners subsidize lower earners
- Quality first: Architectural competitions, high design standards
- Long-term planning: Multi-decade development strategies

YOU MADE IT TO THE END!

ABOUT

Thank you for flipping through this short graphic report on the ongoing Irish housing crisis!

This project was a one man effort, researched, analysed, designed and executed in under 3 weeks. As a business student dipping his toes in the field of data and with experience in graphic design; I aim to create eye-catching and digestible pieces which spark awareness and action.

I hope you enjoyed the read, and don't plan on buying a house in Dublin anytime soon.

With thanks to Professor Tedi Skiti for conceptual guidance.

Links

[LinkedIn](#)



[GitHub](#)



[Kaggle](#)



[Tableau](#)



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